

Austin Melendez

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Senior Developer & Product Designer

Developer and Product Designer with almost a decade of professional expertise in designing & developing websites/web apps and working with emerging technologies. Expert knowledge of HTML5 and CSS3 (Sass & LESS), specializing in CSS animations and micro-interactions. Well-versed in JavaScript (React & Vue) and TypeScript, with a strong focus on accessibility best practices (WCAG 2.1 AA). Has created engaging and high performing digital experiences for brands ranging from Fortune 500 financial services firms to ivy league higher education organizations, healthcare systems, consumer brands, and non-profits. History of success collaborating with creative, UX, CRM, marketing, accessibility, cybersecurity, and project & account management teams in the delivery of enterprise-level digital experiences.

Core Competencies

- HTML5
- CSS3, Sass, Less
- JavaScript
- TypeScript
- React
- Product Design
- User Experience (UX)
- User Interface (UI)
- CSS Animations
- Wireframing
- Prototyping
- Branding
- Illustrating
- Animating
- 3D Rendering
- Graphic Design
- Accessibility
- Visual Storytelling
- Photography

Professional Experience

Senior Front-End Developer

Merge | September 2024 – Present

Lead website and/or app development on the front-end to ensure final projects meet design and technical requirements and deliver final products on time. Work closely with back-end, UX/UI, and business analyst departments to build exceptional products

- Design and implement modern website architecture using React, Next.js, and TypeScript, on headless CMSs, improving performance, maintainability, and developer workflow
- Lead the redesign and frontend development of production websites using Figma for UI/UX design and translating designs into responsive, accessible React components

- Establish and maintain code quality standards through ESLint, TypeScript typing, and structured project configuration, improving reliability and maintainability across codebases
- Build scalable front-end features including user authentication flows, profile management, and dynamic content rendering for web applications
- Contribute to Communities of Practice and Working Groups aimed at analyzing and standardizing processes within all departments across the company

Sr. Web Designer

Finalsite | July 2023 – September 2024

Responsible for creating effective designs for clients in close collaboration with project managers and front-end developers. Working well within project constraints, including client goals, accessibility guidelines, branding requirements, technical considerations, project budgets, and timelines.

- Design responsive sites for use in Finalsite's CMS
- Create a mixture of unique, specific pages and comprehensive visual systems for each client
- Take creative control of projects, serving as the key point of contact for project design direction and decisions
- Create new design solutions and work within existing structures
- Assist in the execution and maintenance of internal design needs such as Theme designs (our website templates), shared base files, and more
- Consult with clients to provide direction and leadership, communicating persuasively and welcoming them into our design process
- Exercise judgment in determining both the strategic and tactical approaches for project-specific design initiatives

React Developer & Product Designer

Nifty's | July 2021- Feb 2023

An integral part of launching, maintaining, and improving Nifty's NFT Marketplace. Notable clients include Warner Brothers, Sony, Damien Hirst, Discovery Channel, and more.

- Assessed user journeys to produce wireframes and optimize user experience throughout the marketplace
- Produced high fidelity page layouts and prototypes, brand & marketing assets
- Created illustrations & animations to be converted into NFTs for clients to sell on the marketplace
- Developed HTML components and page layouts using React and TypeScript and styled them using Sass according to approved designs and wireframes
- Used pure CSS and/or JavaScript to create animations for a more unique and memorable experience for the users

Experience Developer

Primacy | July 2016 – July 2021

Notable clients included Aetna, The Hartford, Boston College, MIT, University of Kansas Health System, UChicago Medicine, Rice University, Curry College, University of Pittsburgh (launching Q2 2021), Joslin Diabetes Center and more.

- Collaborated with UX and Creative teams to seamlessly translate build requirements, wireframes, and creative executions into digital experiences
- Built page templates in HTML and styled templates using CSS (Sass or LESS)
- Added UI functionality using JavaScript, jQuery, or pure CSS
- Worked in various tech stacks as specified by clients or internal teams to meet business requirements, including but not limited to frameworks such as React or Vue
- Worked with CMSs including Sitecore, Drupal, Ingeniux, Prismic, and other proprietary systems
- Integrated websites with Pardot, Salesforce (Marketing Cloud), Google Analytics, HubSpot, and other open-source CRMs
- Transformed and rendered data from APIs
- Performed quality assurance with cross-browser and responsive testing to ensure alignment with creative intent, business requirements and core functionality
- Developed responsive, accessible HTML email marketing templates and newsletter templates
- Develop animated banner ads for clients using HTML & CSS and animation libraries such as GSAP and Animate.css

Graphic Designer

Travelers Insurance | Feb 2014 – July 2016

Worked as part of the Creative Services team with a wide range of responsibilities.

- Ideated and designed logos, brand guidelines, web assets, and social media posts.
- Lead the creative for the ThinkSafe campaign
- Conceptualized and designed web layouts for primary Travelers Insurance website.
- Storyboarded, recorded, and edit internal and external videos
- Performed, recorded, and mastered voiceovers
- Shot and edited photographs for internal communications, external public relations, and investor relations
- Managed and organized stock photography and video filing system